

TidyTissue — The Tissue Box With a Built-In Bin

Pull, wipe, drop — no second trash can needed.

What It Is

TidyTissue is a redesigned tissue box with a sealed trash compartment built into the bottom. You pull a tissue from the top, use it, and drop it straight back into the lower chamber — so used tissues never pile up on the desk, nightstand, or car seat. It's a tiny, obvious fix to an everyday annoyance, which is exactly why people react with "why didn't this exist before?"

How It Makes Money

This is a physical product business. You sell direct-to-consumer through your own Shopify store and marketplaces, plus wholesale to offices, clinics, and car-accessory retailers. Impulse-priced, demo-friendly, and highly giftable — perfect for short-form video ads where the "drop the tissue inside" reveal does the selling. Refill tissue packs create repeat revenue.

Startup Costs

- Product tooling/sampling and first inventory from Alibaba ("tissue box with built-in trash compartment" or custom-molded): **per-unit landed cost ~\$2.50–\$5.00** in MOQ of 500–1,000.
- Initial order (1,000 units): **~\$3,000–\$5,000** including freight.
- Custom branding/packaging: **\$400–\$1,200**.
- Shopify store + theme + apps: **\$50–\$150/month**.
- Product video + photography: **\$300–\$1,000** (or DIY).
- Ad testing budget: **\$1,000–\$2,500**.
- **Lean start: ~\$5,000–\$9,000**.

The Numbers

Landed cost per unit $\approx$ **\$3.50**. Sell price **\$19.99** (impulse "as seen on social" pricing). After $\sim$ \$5 fulfillment/shipping and ~~\$4 blended ad cost per sale~~, net profit $\sim$ **\$7–\$8 per unit**. At 30 sales/day = ~~**\$600 revenue/day, ~\$220 profit/day $\rightarrow$ ~\$6,600/month**~~ in month one, scaling as winning ads compound. Add refill tissue 3-packs at \$9.99 (cost ~~\$2~~) for a recurring ~~**\$6 profit**~~ per reorder. Wholesale pallets to offices at \$9/unit move volume with thinner but reliable margins.

How To Start

1. Order 3–5 samples from different Alibaba suppliers; test build quality, the bin seal, and how cleanly tissues drop in.
2. Pick the best supplier, negotiate MOQ and custom logo/packaging, place a 500–1,000 unit order.
3. Build a clean one-product Shopify store with strong before/after copy and the "hidden bin" demo as the hero.
4. Film 3–5 short vertical ads showing the satisfying drop-in moment from different angles.
5. Launch TikTok and Meta ad tests at small daily budgets; kill losers, scale the winner.
6. Fulfill via your supplier (dropship to validate) then move to bulk + a 3PL once sales are steady.
7. Add refill packs and an office/clinic wholesale page once a winning ad is found.

Where To Get Customers

TikTok Shop and TikTok/Meta paid ads (the demo is the hook), Amazon and Etsy listings, gift guides, and B2B outreach to offices, dental/medical clinics, salons, and auto-accessory shops. Seed free units to home-organization and "useful gadget" creators for organic UGC.

Pro Tips

- The whole sale is the visual — lead every ad with the used-tissue-drops-inside moment in the first second; explain nothing.
- Offer a 2-pack and 3-pack bundle to lift average order value; people buy one for the desk, one for the car, one for the nightstand.
- Lock a slightly differentiated design (better seal, premium finish, or refill-pack ecosystem) so copycats can't undercut you the moment it trends.